

“Man will not get anything unless he works hard” (Surah al-Najm, 53:39).

ENG508 FINAL TERM MCQS 2023-2024

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1. The lexical items that _____ context in the way are called 'deictic'.

- A) démodé
- B) implode
- C) decode
- D) encode

Correct Option: D) encode

Explanation: The handout states that *"the lexical items that encode context in the way are called 'deictics'."* These words point to aspects of the utterance context like time, place, and person.

2. Particularized conversational implicatures (PCIs) are the inferences which are worked out while drawing _____ on the specific context of the utterance.

- A) totally
- B) None of the given options
- C) partially
- D) moderately

Correct Option: A) totally

Explanation: The handout defines PCIs as “inferences which are worked out while drawing *totally* on the specific context of the utterance”.

3. Deborah Tannen (1986) claimed that Grice's maxims of cooperative discourse can't apply to _____ conversations.

- A) Intrinsic
- B) feigned
- C) real
- D) flexible

Correct Option: C) real

Explanation: The handout clearly states: "*Tannen (1986) claims that Grice's maxims of cooperative discourse can't apply to 'real conversations'.*".

4. H. Paul Grice's central claim was that the predominant principle of human interaction was an _____ towards cooperative behavior.

- A) gripe
- B) groan
- C) animus
- D) impulse

Correct Option: D) impulse

Explanation: Grice viewed cooperative interaction as a natural impulse. The handout says he believed most discourse participants are "capable of making themselves understood" due to this cooperative tendency.

5. When a speaker may flout the conversational maxim in several ways, e.g., exaggerating as in hyperbole and using metaphor, etc. This is called _____.

- A) flouting quality
- B) flouting manner
- C) flouting quantity
- D) flouting relevance

Correct Option: A) flouting quality

Explanation: According to the handout, "*Flouting quality – speaker may do it in several ways e.g. exaggerating as in hyperbole, using metaphor, irony, and banter.*".

6. In strong implicature, a speaker intends that her hearer grasp a _____ implication without which the utterance would not be relevant.

- A) natural
- B) general
- C) particular
- D) symbolic

Correct Option: C) particular

Explanation: According to the handout, a strong implicature is one where a speaker intends the hearer to grasp a **particular implication** without which the utterance would not be relevant.

7. In properties of conversational implicature, cancellability is also known as _____.

- A) meliority
- B) calculability
- C) expediency
- D) defeasibility

Correct Option: D) defeasibility

Explanation: The handout clearly states: "Cancellability is also known as **defeasibility**." This refers to the idea that implicatures can be canceled without contradiction.

8. Which of the following maxims indicates that the speaker should be as informative as is required?

- A) quality
- B) quantity
- C) relation
- D) manner

Correct Option: B) quantity

Explanation: The **maxim of quantity** instructs that one should be as informative as required, neither too little nor too much.

9. Weak implicature is the weaker the encouragement, and the _____ the range of possibilities among which the hearer can choose, the weaker the implicatures.

- A) tinier
- B) wider
- C) slender
- D) slighter

Correct Option: B) wider

Explanation: According to the handout: "The **wider** the range of possibilities... the weaker the implicatures" in the case of weak implicature.

10. Social Debts refers to expressions which clearly _____ social meaning.

- A) encode
- B) devote
- C) erode
- D) decode

Correct Option: A) encode

Explanation: The handout defines **Social Debts** as "expressions which clearly **encode** social meaning," like greetings and farewells.

11. Spatial deixis is used to indicate the relative _____ of people and things.

- A) time
- B) domain
- C) state
- D) location

Correct Option: D) location

Explanation: The handout defines spatial deixis as expressions used to indicate the relative **location** of people and things, e.g., "here", "there".

12. Deictic expressions such as "that," "those," or "these" are called _____.

- A) definite and specific pronouns
- B) indefinite and specific pronouns
- C) none of the above given options
- D) indefinite and non-specific pronouns

Correct Option: A) definite and specific pronouns

Explanation: Demonstratives like "this," "that," "these," and "those" are used with specific reference, and are considered definite pronouns in deixis.

13. A positive cognitive effect is a worthwhile _____ to the individual's representation of the world.

- A) concurrence
- B) difference
- C) accord
- D) similarity

Correct Option: B) difference

Explanation: The handout states that a positive cognitive effect is a worthwhile **difference** to the individual's mental model of the world.

14. Relevance theory is seen as a _____ theory because of its focus on the use of language in communication.

- A) discourse
- B) translation
- C) semantics
- D) pragmatic

Correct Option: D) pragmatic

Explanation: Relevance theory is described as a **pragmatic** theory in the handout, due to its concern with language use and communication.

15. The conceptual-procedural distinction was introduced into _____ theory by Diane Blakemore (1987).

- A) syntactic
- B) relevance
- C) propositional
- D) color

Correct Option: B) relevance

Explanation: Diane Blakemore introduced the conceptual–procedural distinction in **relevance theory** in 1987.

16. According to H. Paul Grice, it is the knowledge of the maxims that allows hearers to draw _____ about the speakers' intentions and applied meaning.

- A) anticipant
- B) plight
- C) inference
- D) discourse

Correct Option: C) inference

Explanation: Grice's theory emphasizes that listeners draw **inferences** based on conversational maxims to understand implied meanings.

17. Which among the following is a conversational implicature that is inferable without reference to a special context?

- A) generalized implicature
- B) conventional implicature
- C) scalar implicature
- D) societal implicature

Correct Option: A) generalized implicature

Explanation: Generalized conversational implicatures do not rely on a specific context for inference; they are assumed by default.

18. Temporal deixis is also known as _____ deixis.

- A) time
- B) social

- C) spatial
- D) person

Correct Option: A) time

Explanation: The handout defines **temporal deixis** as deixis related to **time**, involving expressions like "now", "then", "tomorrow".

19. The British philosopher H. Paul Grice is regarded as an eminent representative of _____ language philosophy.

- A) sole
- B) ordinary
- C) specific
- D) abstract

Correct Option: B) ordinary

Explanation: Grice is recognized for his work in **ordinary language philosophy**, which focuses on everyday language use.

20. Conventional implicatures are a/an _____ part of meaning and must be learned 'ad hoc'.

- A) arbitrary
- B) circumspect
- C) explicit
- D) palpable

Correct Option: A) arbitrary

Explanation: The handout notes that conventional implicatures are an **arbitrary** part of meaning and must be learned separately.

21. The term "deixis" is derived from the _____ language.

- A) French
- B) Greek
- C) Sanskrit
- D) Italian

Correct Option: B) Greek

Explanation: The handout explains that the term “deixis” is derived from Greek, meaning “pointing” or “indicating”.

22. The term "implicature" accounts for what a speaker can _____ as distinct from what the speaker literally says.

- A) suggest
- B) imply
- C) mean
- D) All of the above options

Correct Option: D) All of the above options

Explanation: The handout states implicature “accounts for what a speaker can **imply, suggest or mean**, as distinct from what is literally said”.

23. Which of the following is said directly in an utterance or a sentence?

- A) explicature
- B) implicature
- C) dissension
- D) transmutation

Correct Option: A) explicature

Explanation: Explicature is defined as the content **explicitly conveyed** in an utterance, forming a development of the logical form of the sentence.

24. The term "deixis" is also known as the _____ of language.

- A) perplexity
- B) complexity
- C) indexicality
- D) multiplicity

Correct Option: C) indexicality

Explanation: The handout refers to deixis as the “**indexicality of language**”, highlighting its pointing function in context.

25. It is very _____ for the speaker to update the deictic center in more extended discourse.

- A) exceptional
- B) common
- C) intrinsic
- D) endemic

Correct Option: B) common

Explanation: According to the handout, “it is very common for the speaker to update the deictic center in extended discourse” when context shifts.

26. The default deictic center is the speaker’s _____ at the time of utterance.

- A) turf
- B) location
- C) peut
- D) sump

Correct Option: B) location

Explanation: The handout clearly states that the default deictic center is the speaker’s location at the time of speaking.

27. A scalar implicature is a quantity implicature based on the use of an informationally _____ term in an implicational scale.

- A) weak
- B) strong
- C) mild
- D) stable

Correct Option: A) weak

Explanation: Scalar implicatures involve using a weak term when a stronger one is possible, creating a quantity-based inference.

28. When flouting a maxim, the speaker assumes that the hearer knows that their words should NOT be taken at face value and they can infer the meaning.

- A) implicit
- B) distant
- C) explicit
- D) apostate

Correct Option: C) explicit

Explanation: The speaker's violation is **explicit** in flouting maxims, allowing the hearer to infer intended meaning beyond the literal.

29. Spatial deixis is also known as _____.

- A) choice deixis
- B) place deixis
- C) integral deixis
- D) domain deixis

Correct Option: B) place deixis

Explanation: The handout explains that **spatial deixis** is also called "**place deixis**", dealing with location-based references.

30. Wilson and Sperber classified Relevance theory into _____ main principles.

- A) six
- B) two
- C) four
- D) five

Correct Option: B) two

Explanation: Relevance Theory is divided into **two main principles**: the Cognitive Principle and the Communicative Principle.

31. Maxim violation is unostentatiously quiet. _____.

- A) deceiving
- B) computing
- C) clearing
- D) freeing

Correct Option: A) deceiving

Explanation: The handout explains that maxim violation is “**unostentatiously, quiet deceiving**”, especially when hiding truth or misleading without drawing attention.

32. Deictic referents are typically denotations with _____ descriptive power because of the role of assumed knowledge in determining reference.

- A) shoal
- B) topical
- C) flash
- D) limited

Correct Option: D) limited

Explanation: Deictic referents rely on shared context, so they have **limited descriptive power** compared to proper nouns or full descriptions.

33. Discourse Debts is also called _____ debts.

- A) substance
- B) text
- C) material
- D) treatise

Correct Option: B) text

Explanation: The handout states: “**Discourse deixis is also called text deixis**”, as it refers to references made to parts of discourse like "this chapter", "the above" etc..

34. The second utterance is always a response to the first in _____.

- A) rotational pairs
- B) adjacency pairs
- C) sequential pairs
- D) nominal pairs

Correct Option: B) adjacency pairs

Explanation: Adjacency pairs are defined in the handout as “a sequence of two related utterances by two different speakers,” where the second is a response to the first.

35. Listener cues are also called _____ channel cues.

- A) down
- B) front
- C) middle
- D) back

Correct Option: D) back

Explanation: The handout identifies **backchannel cues** as listener signals like “uh-huh”, “yeah”, and gestures that show attentiveness.

36. Demonstratives are often accompanied by a gesture that demonstrates the object _____.

- A) All of the given options
- B) referred
- C) pointing
- D) gazing

Correct Option: A) All of the given options

Explanation: Demonstratives such as “this” and “that” are often used with gestures like pointing, gazing, or referencing to **identify the object referred to.**

37. For the collection of qualitative data through conversation, note down the opening words of each speaker can be a _____ method.

- A) lightproof
- B) foolproof
- C) reproof
- D) shellproof

Correct Option: B) foolproof

Explanation: Recording opening words of each speaker is mentioned as a **foolproof method** in qualitative conversational research.

38. Conversational analysis examines _____ levels of meaning within a text.

- A) same
- B) wiles
- C) different
- D) guile

Correct Option: C) different

Explanation: Conversational analysis aims to explore the **different levels of meaning** in interactions—verbal, non-verbal, structural, etc..

39. The topic of a sentence is its _____ of attention.

- A) center
- B) ending
- C) beginning
- D) None of the given option

Correct Option: A) center

Explanation: The topic in pragmatics and discourse is often referred to as the **center of attention**—what the utterance is about.

40. As an interactive feature of talk, reference entails _____ meanings.

- A) semantic
- B) psychological
- C) phonetic
- D) pragmatic

Correct Option: D) pragmatic

Explanation: Reference, especially in interactional talk, conveys **pragmatic meaning**—it depends on use, context, and intended effect.

41. The building of corpora of written language has proceeded more _____ than the compilation of spoken corpora.

- A) adamantly
- B) conversely
- C) mutually
- D) quickly

Correct Option: D) quickly

Explanation: The handout notes that building corpora of **written language has proceeded more quickly** than spoken corpora due to easier access and processing of written text.

42. Interlanguage pragmatics focuses on the _____ development of second/foreign language learners.

- A) cognitive
- B) pragmatic
- C) semantic
- D) phonetic

Correct Option: B) pragmatic

Explanation: **Interlanguage pragmatics focuses on the pragmatic development** of L2 learners as they acquire skills for effective communication in the target language.

43. The kind of research that studies real and observable phenomena is usually known as _____.

- A) phenomenological
- B) empirical

- C) narrative
- D) grounded theory

Correct Option: B) empirical

Explanation: The handout refers to **empirical research** as a method to study real, testable phenomena under controlled conditions.

44. Conventional transcriptions of conversations use standard _____ transcription script to keep the record of the data.

- A) phonemic
- B) allophonic
- C) orthographic
- D) morphemic

Correct Option: C) orthographic

Explanation: The handout confirms that conventional conversation transcriptions typically use **orthographic script**, not phonemic or other systems.

45. The term "communicative _____" was invented by the anthropologist and sociolinguist Dell Hymes.

- A) competence
- B) intellectuality
- C) strategy
- D) performance

Correct Option: A) competence

Explanation: Dell Hymes coined the term **communicative competence** to refer to knowledge of sociocultural rules in communication.

46. Given information is the kind of information which is currently in the _____ of an addressee's mind.

- A) prohibition
- B) left sphere

- C) right sphere
- D) forefront

Correct Option: D) forefront

Explanation: **Given information** is what is **already in the forefront** of the listener's mind during interaction, as noted in the handout.

47. Intercultural pragmatics is based on the _____ approach.

- A) psycho-cognitive
- B) philosopher-cognitive
- C) socio-cognitive
- D) None of the given options

Correct Option: C) socio-cognitive

Explanation: The handout describes **intercultural pragmatics** as being based on a **socio-cognitive approach** that connects mental and cultural context.

48. These types of signals (uh-uh, yeah, mmm) provide feedback to the current speaker that the message is being received, known as _____.

- A) middle-channels
- B) initial-channels
- C) forward-channels
- D) back-channel

Correct Option: D) back-channel

Explanation: The handout explains that feedback signals like “uh-uh,” “yeah,” etc., are called **back-channel cues**.

49. Which among the following is the term used for compiling collections of texts and using them to probe language use?

- A) corpus linguistics
- B) socio linguistics
- C) psycho linguistics
- D) philosophe linguistics

Correct Option: A) corpus linguistics

Explanation: **Corpus linguistics** involves compiling text collections (corpora) to analyze and understand language use patterns.

50. In relevance theory, attributive use of a concept is where a word or phrase is used to express a concept that a speaker attributes to ____.

- A) herself
- B) himself
- C) themselves
- D) someone else

Correct Option: D) someone else

Explanation: In **relevance theory**, attributive use means the speaker uses a word/phrase to express a concept they **attribute to someone else**.

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